Practice workbook · How long and how much: duration and capacity

Duration and capacity of short-term and long-term memory.

5 question parts: 1 worked-example retry and 4 further practice parts.
Name: _____ Class: _____ Date: _____

Practise one question type at a time. Attempt the part inside the red boundary; the rest of the question and any figures are kept for context. Write your working in the answer space.

The first question is a retry of the website worked example, without its solution. Check your answers online with 'Check my answer', or ask your teacher for the answer booklet.

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Type ID: PSY-MEM-02

1. Question 9 · part a · 2 marks

2022 JUN · Paper 01

Worked-example retry · Attempt part a only.

9 Nishka was interested in the amount of numbers that a person could remember over a short period of time.

She presented a group of participants with seven number lists. The number lists were shown one by one to the group. Each number list increased in length with each successive trial, up to a maximum of 10 numbers (see **Figure 3**).

Nishka's number lists

Trial 1:	**8**	**1**	**5**	**0**					
Trial 2:	**4**	**2**	**3**	**9**	**6**				
Trial 3:	**3**	**8**	**1**	**0**	**4**	**5**			
Trial 4:	**2**	**7**	**1**	**5**	**6**	**9**	**1**		
Trial 5:	**5**	**0**	**2**	**1**	**7**	**3**	**8**	**4**	
Trial 6:	**0**	**2**	**9**	**1**	**3**	**0**	**4**	**7**	**5**
Trial 7:	**1**	**6**	**2**	**7**	**8**	**4**	**1**	**3**	**5**	**2**

Figure 3

At the end of each trial, participants had to write down the numbers in the order that they saw them. Participants only continued to the next trial if they successfully completed the previous trial.

(a) Explain, using your knowledge of the capacity of short-term memory, what Nishka is likely to find.

(2)

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1. Question 9 · part a · 2 marks

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Worked-example retry · Attempt part a only.

(b) Explain **one** improvement Nishka could make to her study.

(2)

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(Total for Question 9 = 4 marks)

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Working and answer

2. Question 7 · part a · 1 mark

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Further practice · Attempt part a only.

7 Toby has collected 10 different types of dinosaur. He is trying to remember the names of all the dinosaurs he has collected.

Define what is meant by the following terms in relation to Toby's memory of his dinosaurs.

(a) Duration

(1)

(b) Capacity

(1)

(Total for Question 7 = 2 marks)

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Working and answer

3. Question 7 · part b · 1 mark

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Further practice · Attempt part b only.

7 Toby has collected 10 different types of dinosaur. He is trying to remember the names of all the dinosaurs he has collected.

Define what is meant by the following terms in relation to Toby's memory of his dinosaurs.

(a) Duration

(1)

.....

.....

.....

(b) Capacity

(1)

.....

.....

.....

(Total for Question 7 = 2 marks)

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Working and answer

4. Question 6 · part whole · 2 marks

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Further practice · Attempt part whole only.

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6 State **one** feature of each of the following as part of short-term memory.

Duration

Capacity

(Total for Question 6 = 2 marks)

Working and answer

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5. Question 6 · part whole · 1 mark

2024 JUN · Paper 01

Further practice · Attempt part whole only.

6 Identify which of the following would be the most appropriate to define the capacity of the short-term memory.

- ☒ **A** 3 ± 2 digits
- ☒ **B** 5 ± 2 digits
- ☒ **C** 7 ± 2 digits
- ☒ **D** 9 ± 2 digits

(Total for Question 6 = 1 mark)

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Working and answer

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